Brice Fernandes

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Summary A versatile senior engineering leader who builds capability: in systems, in teams, and in the people who lead them. Experienced across the full software life cycle in complex and demanding environments, from embedded engineering to cloud-native architecture to running an engineering function, with unusual depth in governance, security and data protection. Key Achievements include being a founding coach on the University of Cambridge Judge Business School Startup Accelerator programmes and foundational contributions to the GitOps methodology.

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Skills

Leadership & Management: Engineering strategy and vision, Org design and resourcing, Budget ownership, R&D leadership, Technical recruitment, Career frameworks and progression, People development and coaching, Delivery and operations, Customer Experience, Site Reliability Engineering, Incident response and business continuity, Agile principles (Scrum, Kanban and Extreme Programming practices), Lean software development, Full product development life-cycle, Technical training and skill assessment, Business modelling, Systemic innovation.

Governance & Compliance: Data protection (GDPR, ROPA, registered DPO), Security programme ownership, Cyber Essentials+, Vendor security assessment, Data residency, Risk management, Policy and audit.

Platforms: Cloud Native, GitOps, AWS, GCP, Multi-cloud, Hybrid Cloud, Kubernetes, Terraform, Prometheus, Grafana, Linux administration.

Software Development: Functional Programming, Python, Javascript (ES6, React, NodeJS), Go, Rust, C, C#, F#, Clojure, Scheme, Test Driven Development, Git, LLM-assisted development workflows, Agent-based modelling, Natural language processing.

Publications

The Evolution of Complementary Cognition: Humans Cooperatively Adapt and Evolve through a System of Collective Cognitive Search.
Taylor, H., Fernandes, B., & Wraight, S. (2021). Cambridge Archaeological Journal, 1-17.
doi: 10.1017/S0959774321000329

Relevant Experience

Director of Engineering at Raspberry Pi Foundation September 2024 - Present

Engineering leader for the Foundation's Digital Products division, accountable for engineering across multiple product teams building the learning platforms used by young people and educators worldwide. Line manager to the Engineering Manager cohort, reporting to the Chief Technology and Product Officer. Owned engineering vision and strategy, org design and resourcing, the engineering budget, and the security, compliance and data-protection posture of the digital estate. Member of the foundation's leadership team, representing engineering to the executive and management board.

- Designed and landed a technology-agnostic engineering career framework (Apprentice to Principal, plus a distinct management track), now in active use across 1:1s, reviews and progression decisions
- Established a working-group operating model with charters, tiers and explicit decision rights: eight autonomous groups covering security, architecture, AI, accessibility and people development with delegated authority and budget
- Owned the US and global data residency strategy for a public-sector opportunity of ∼1M students, authoring the costed brief that framed the executive decision

- Built the Foundation-wide data map (~90 systems, 20 data categories, 25 data flows) as the evidence base for ROPA and ongoing privacy compliance
- Led the compliance and security programme for Digital Products: Cyber Essentials+, vendor security assessments, cloud access audits, software approval, business continuity and incident response
- Directed engineering AI adoption through an adoption plan, a dedicated working group, and an adoption-maturity reporting tool built with external partners
- Grew and stabilised the team through recruitment at every level, contractor procurement, and structured investment in people development, with measurable gains in retention

KEYWORDS: *Engineering Leadership, Org Design, Career Frameworks, People Development, Recruitment, Engineering Strategy, Architecture, Data Protection, GDPR, ROPA, Compliance, Cyber Essentials+, Security, Budget Ownership, Delivery Management, AI Adoption, Education, Non-profit*

DevOps Practice Leader at Capgemini January 2022 - June 2024
Senior Leader of the DevOps practice for Capgemini UK Digital Customer Experience (DCX). Worked on commercial proposition development, aligning product, service and capability with both clients, market units, and other delivery areas in DCX and beyond. Owned the technology radar and external thought leadership for DevOps practice within the DCX delivery unit. Delivered client engagements for some of the UK's largest organisations.

- Worked on all aspects of capability management (Products and offers, culture, training, recruitment, career framework)
- Senior technical leader on client engagements
- Owned technical architecture and ways of working on client engagements
- Security cleared to work on National Critical Infrastructure
- Managed and mentored other senior leaders
- Became Capgemini Global DevOps Community's UK point of contact

KEYWORDS: *Senior Leadership, Capability Management, Architecture, Delivery Management, Digital Transformation, Recruitment, Product Management, National Critical Infrastructure*

Senior Solution Architect at Weaveworks September 2018 - September 2021
Architected, developed and delivered hybrid cloud application platforms for some of the company's most high-profile clients, including in multiple regulated industries. Responsible for both project technical leadership and client relationships.

Worked on all aspects of commercial engagements, from pre-sales to delivery management. Was responsible for the design and delivery of GitOps and Cloud Native training for clients and partners.

- Provided architecture consultancy for internal application platforms to global banks
- Led the design and architecture of the internal application platform to support the autonomous vehicle project of one of the world's largest companies
- Led the initial design and architecture workshop for the re-platforming effort of a large European telecommunication provider
- Defined the principles of GitOps
- Trusted key-holder for critical internal systems
- Designed and implemented customer experience playbook
- Designed and delivered public and private Cloud Native training

KEYWORDS: *GitOps, Customer Experience, Delivery management, Kubernetes, Cloud Native, Pre-sales engineering, Monitoring, Observability, Digital transformation, SRE, Training, Recruitment*

Senior Development Engineer at Weaveworks September 2017 - September 2018
Developed Go tools for managing Kubernetes. Helped define the GitOps methodology and communicate it to the developer community. Presented GitOps to conferences in the UK and internationally and delivered training on Kubernetes and GitOps. Member of the on-call

engineering team directly responsible for the uptime and maintenance of our online SaaS platform.
KEYWORDS: *Kubernetes, GitOps, Cloud Native, Prometheus, Terraform, Go, On-Call, Incident response, DevOps, SRE, Developer Experience, Training, Recruitment*

Founder at Decacoder October 2015 - January 2017
Founded an online education company delivering high quality online education to developers via a custom platform. I led the development of a scalable media delivery platform from scratch while also being responsible for all other business areas. I also set up a continuous integration and continuous deployment pipeline using AWS services, and was responsible for the educational design and user experience of all students using the platform. Also became registered Data Protection Officer for the company.
KEYWORDS: *Product development, Leadership, Javascript, ES6, React, Babel, Firebase, Continuous integration, Continuous deployment, AWS, Gulp, Stripe, Education, UX*

Startup Mentor & Founding Coach, Accelerate Cambridge 2013 - 2016
I was selected to be a founding coach and mentor for the University of Cambridge Judge Business School startup accelerator Accelerate Cambridge. I delivered a startup founder education curriculum and coached teams on product design, technology strategy, development process, team management, pitching for investment and clear communication. Several of the startups I mentored received prestigious awards, including winning the Pitch@Palace competition.
KEYWORDS: *Startups, Coaching, Business modelling, Pitching, Leadership, Investment, Technology Strategy*

Instructor & Coach, Ignite Programme July 2015, July 2017
Instructor and coach for the University of Cambridge Judge Business School Ignite programme. The Ignite programme is a one week course aimed at transforming existing early stage enterprises through high quality lectures and challenging workshops. Responsible for leading workshops during the programme, ensuring that attendees adopted the knowledge shared into their business practice.
KEYWORDS: *Startups, Education, Coaching, Leadership, Event facilitation, Business Modelling*

Founder, Cambridge Programmer Study Group July 2014 - December 2016
Founded the most active programming meetup in Cambridge, meeting twice a week to study computer science topics. Over two years we studied Machine Learning, Cryptography, Concurrency and Functional programming, amongst other topics.
KEYWORDS: *Machine Learning, Functional Programming, Scheme, SICP, Neural Networks, Cryptography, Concurrency, Computer architecture, Compilers, Interpreters, Community building*

Instructor, Unity3D Development Course August 2014 - August 2015
Successfully kickstarted an online tutorial series on game development using the Unity3D game engine. Designed a curriculum to teach programming for game development in the C# language, including the fundamentals of computer science to a novice audience. The project was delivered over the Udemy.com online platform and reached over 100 000 students. The complete course was accredited for higher education credits and worth 10 European Credit Transfer System credits ($\sim$10% of an undergraduate degree).
KEYWORDS: *Education, Unity3D, C#, Game Development, Screencasting, Kickstarter, Video production*

Software Engineer, Cambridge Broadband March 2011 - October 2013
Developed and maintained a wide range of software to enable and support a microwave backhaul product at Cambridge Broadband. Worked on cross platform graphical user applications, embedded C network management using SNMP, internal tools and existing product maintenance. Was also part of a process improvement team that re-designed the software and product development process for the company. Took responsibility for technical recruitment of C developers, drafting requests for quotes and selecting and managing contractors.
KEYWORDS: *C, PPC, Embedded, Python, Linux, GTK, SNMP, Agile, RFQ, Recruitment*

Certifications

Santa Fe Institute Introduction to Agent Based Modelling	Completed August 2024
Scrum Alliance Certified Agile Leadership 2	Valid to August 2026
Scrum Alliance Certified Agile Leadership 1	Valid to August 2025
AWS Certified Machine Learning - Specialty	Valid to October 2025
AWS Certified Security - Specialty	Valid to October 2025
AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Professional	Valid to September 2023
AWS Certified DevOps Engineer - Professional	Valid to October 2023
MIT Media Lab: AI-Generated Media Course	Completed October 2021

Selected Talks

Embedded Test Driven Development — March 2024
Slides and code available

SRE Best Practices — October 2020
Video available

Bret Fisher's Docker and DevOps Podcast — November 2019
Video available

Delivering Quality at Speed with GitOps — August 2019
Video available

Building Objects With Functions — June 2015
An interactive version as well as a recording are available.

Education

The University Of Sheffield — 2006 - 2010
BSc. Physics with Computer Science